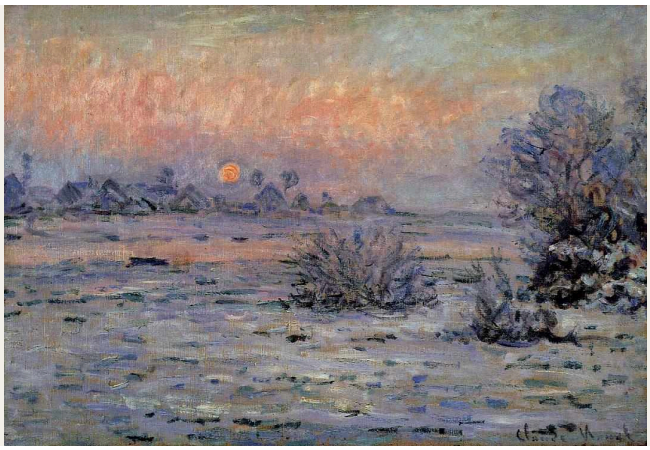
LE HAVRE, FRANCE

MuMa — Musée d’art moderne André Malraux: Masterpieces

Twenty works in which weather, colour and the edge of a form change how a place or person can be seen.



A building may remain recognisable after most of its edges have dissolved. Snow can be painted with blue and violet. A small orange sun can alter the colour relationships across an entire river view. The works gathered here repeatedly test how much description can be carried by light rather than by outline.

Ports and riverbanks provide practical structures for those experiments: a quay recedes, masts divide the sky, a bend gives water a direction. The portraits and interiors introduce another question, how attention is distributed when several surfaces ask to be seen at once. Comparing these pictures makes differences between painters clearer than applying the same label of atmosphere to all of them.

Artline selected these works from documented museum holdings. The selection is independent of the museum, and individual works may be on loan or off display. Dates and attributions retain the qualifications in the linked records.

Explore this selection in Artline

See the selected works alongside books and events from their period, or compare when the artists lived. The books and events provide context, not evidence of direct influence. Works without confirmed dates remain in this guide.

Artworks in context Who lived when?

artlines.org/guides/muma-le-havre

The selection · 20

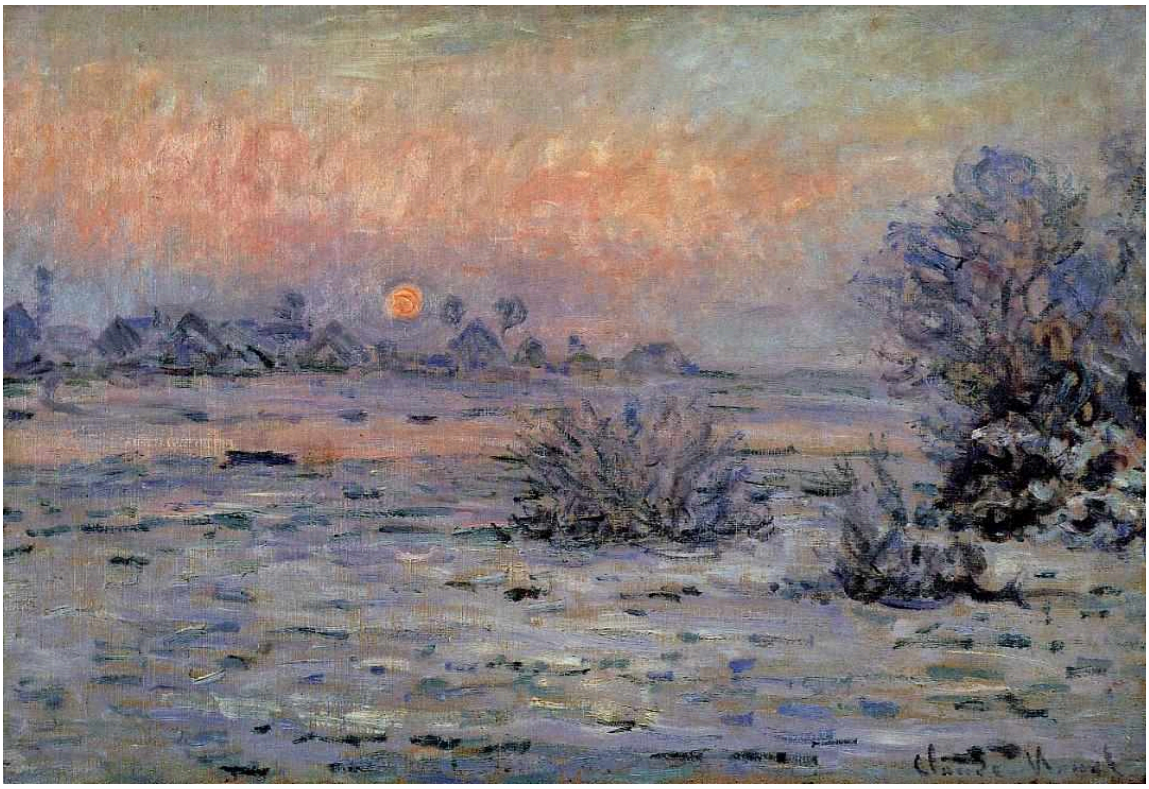
1. Winter Sun at Lavacourt
   Claude Monet · 1879–1880
2. The Houses of Parliament, London
   Claude Monet · 1903
3. Boats and Pier
   Eugène Boudin · 1890–1897
4. Dunkirk, Ramparts and Harbour Entrance
   Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot · 1873
5. The Wave
   Gustave Courbet · 1869
6. The Loing at Saint-Mammès
   Alfred Sisley · 1885
7. Quay at Honfleur
   Johan Jongkind · 1866
8. The Quai du Pothuis, Banks of the Oise
   Camille Pissarro · 1882
9. Sunrise at Éragny
   Camille Pissarro · 1894
10. The Bay of Salerno
    Pierre-Auguste Renoir · 1881
11. Portrait of Nini Lopez
    Pierre-Auguste Renoir · 1876
12. After the Bath, Woman Drying Herself
    Edgar Degas · c. 1884–1886 / 1890 / 1900
13. Woman Seen from Behind
    Pierre-Auguste Renoir · c. 1875–1879
14. Landscape at Champrosay
    Eugène Delacroix · c. 1849
15. Interior with a Balcony
    Pierre Bonnard · 1919
16. The Hill with Poplars
    Paul Sérusier · 1907
17. Still Life with Reeds, Primroses and Maize
    Paul Sérusier · 1904
18. Snowy Landscape at Crozant
    Armand Guillaumin · c. 1895
19. The Quai des Grands-Augustins
    Albert Marquet · 1905–1906
20. Landscape, or Street in the South
    Henri Matisse · 1919

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Winter Sun at Lavacourt

Claude Monet

1879–1880 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Claude Monet. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · Public domain

The sun occupies very little of the canvas, yet its orange changes the surrounding cold colours. Snow and water carry blue, violet and warmer touches rather than a uniform white. Monet's winter of 1879–1880 gives the river a particular condition of visibility. Dark trees and buildings hold their positions while the coloured light alters how their setting is read.

Object source · Open artwork

02 / 20

The Houses of Parliament, London

Claude Monet

1903 · Oil on canvas · Musée d'art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Monetmonetmonet. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 4.0

Recognition survives the loss of sharp edges. The towers remain identifiable through mist, while related colours connect building, sky and broken reflection. A small boat helps locate the water in front of the landmark. This is MuMa's 1903 version; other Parliament paintings test different conditions, so one image should not stand for the whole series.

Object source · Open artwork

03 / 20

Boats and Pier

Eugène Boudin

1890–1897 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

Hulls and masts give the harbour a stable framework, while their reflections break into separate marks. Boudin needs both kinds of description: one keeps boats and pier locatable, the other allows water to remain mobile. Small workers do not gather around a single event. Their dispersed presence keeps the port active within the wide view.

Object source · Open artwork

04 / 20

Dunkirk, Ramparts and Harbour Entrance

Jean-Baptiste-Camille Corot

1873 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

Corot reserves strong contrast for a few points, including the dark tree interrupting the sky. Broad pale ground carries the view toward ramparts and harbour without much busy incident. Beside Boudin's broken reflections, the larger tonal divisions become more apparent. A working port can be made intelligible through spacious relations of light and dark as well as through accumulated detail.

Object source · Open artwork

05 / 20

The Wave

Gustave Courbet

1869 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

The shore boats provide a human measure for the approaching water. Their smallness matters against the heavy sea and dark cloud above. Courbet separates pale breaking crests from dense darker colour, giving the waves mass as well as motion. The threat does not require a depicted disaster; it emerges from the disproportion between the boats and their surroundings.

Object source · Open artwork

06 / 20

The Loing at Saint-Mammès

Alfred Sisley

1885 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

The bank's curve supplies an order beneath the many small marks. Following it brings the eye toward houses and trees, whose firmer middle-distance group steadies the view. Sisley's brushwork can vary across water, ground and foliage because the larger route remains clear. The landscape's apparent ease depends on that simple, durable direction.

Object source · Open artwork

07 / 20

Quay at Honfleur

Johan Jongkind

1866 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

Thin rigging divides the bright sky without closing it. Below, heavier hulls and figures give the waterfront practical scale. Jongkind retains enough harbour equipment for the place to remain a working one, even while light opens the view around it. The difference between a mast's line and a boat's mass is part of that balance.

Object source · Open artwork

08 / 20

The Quai du Pothuis, Banks of the Oise

Camille Pissarro

1882 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrice78500. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 4.0

The path serves people and composition at once. Figures move along it toward distant buildings, while its direction carries the viewer past the resting boat and trees. Pissarro integrates everyday traffic into the bank's recession. MuMa identifies this as the 1882 painting, a useful distinction among several views associated with the Pothuis quay.

Object source · Open artwork

09 / 20

Sunrise at Éragny

Camille Pissarro

1894 · Oil on canvas · Musée d'art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

Trees divide the light into narrow openings. Their structure remains readable beneath repeated touches spread across the ground and vegetation. The small figure becomes one element within that worked surface. Compared with Monet's winter river view, Pissarro's view distributes attention more evenly, making light a condition that recurs through many marks rather than gathering primarily around one small sun.

Object source · Open artwork

10 / 20

The Bay of Salerno

Pierre-Auguste Renoir

1881 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

The busy vegetation makes the simpler water beyond it feel more open. Renoir creates distance partly by changing the amount of activity on the surface: many touches near at hand, fewer broad relations farther away. The sunlit slope becomes an approach to the bay. Depth can emerge from differences in handling without sharply outlining every object.

Object source · Open artwork

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Portrait of Nini Lopez

Pierre-Auguste Renoir

1876 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

The face receives closer definition than much of the dark dress and setting. Small colour changes locate cheeks, eyes and hair, while the blue-green bow provides a separate accent below. Renoir does not give every surface the same descriptive finish. The surrounding looseness helps preserve the named sitter as the portrait's most particular area.

Object source · Open artwork

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After the Bath, Woman Drying Herself

Edgar Degas

c. 1884–1886 / 1890 / 1900 · Pastel on wove paper · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Didier Descouens. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · Public domain

Drying turns the woman's back and bent arm toward the edge of the image. The close framing follows the task's awkward reach rather than arranging a frontal display. Pastel strokes remain active across body and cloth. The museum records successive phases of work, so the qualified sequence of dates should be kept rather than reduced to a single certain year.

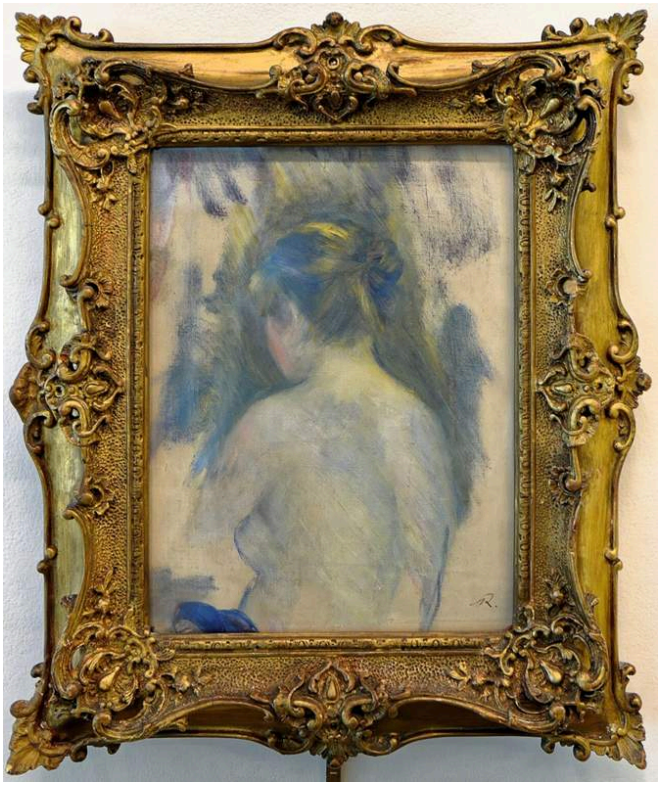
Object source · Open artwork

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Woman Seen from Behind

Pierre-Auguste Renoir

c. 1875–1879 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

Parts of the shoulder and back soften into the surrounding blue, while head and gathered hair are more readily located. The body retains its form without an equally firm edge everywhere. Beside Degas's crossed pastel strokes, Renoir's treatment makes a useful distinction: boundaries can either assert the act of drawing or gradually ease into neighbouring colour.

Object source · Open artwork

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Landscape at Champrosay

Eugène Delacroix

c. 1849 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

Few landmarks compete with the unsettled sky. Dark trees and changes between warm and cool ground provide enough orientation for weather to carry much of the picture's activity. Delacroix establishes scale through the balance of large areas. The landscape does not need a prominent human event to produce a direction of attention or a sense of change.

Object source · Open artwork

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Interior with a Balcony

Pierre Bonnard

1919 · Oil on canvas · Musée d'art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

The bright opening competes with the near table, patterned floor and objects rather than absorbing them into one focal point. Bonnard leaves the eye several plausible places to settle. A figure at the edge joins this distribution of partial attention. The room acquires its familiarity through the number of things that can be noticed separately within it.

Object source · Open artwork · Inventory: 2004.3.1

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The Hill with Poplars

Paul Sérusier

1907 · Oil on canvas · Musée d'art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

Repeated thin trunks provide a screen over the hill's broader colour bands. Sérusier separates two scales of structure, narrow uprights and rounded land, then lets them hold the view together. Fine atmospheric transitions are less necessary when those relations are clear. The landscape's order can be followed through repetition without making every tree identical.

Object source · Open artwork

17 / 20

Still Life with Reeds, Primroses and Maize

Paul Sérusier

1904 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

Tall reeds rise above the compact table group, giving the plants two distinct scales. Their pale lengths repeat against the dark ground while bowls and other forms collect below. The comparison with Sérusier's poplars is useful because the upright device performs related compositional work. Its effect changes when it belongs to a tabletop rather than a distant hill.

Object source · Open artwork

18 / 20

Snowy Landscape at Crozant

Armand Guillaumin

c. 1895 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

Blue and violet shadows make the white ground articulate its slope. Walls and the watercourse interrupt the snow, while warmer branches supply another temperature of colour above it. Guillaumin's valley is more broken and steeply divided than Monet's winter river view. Their comparison shows how coloured snow can describe terrain, not merely decorate a cold scene.

Object source · Open artwork

19 / 20

The Quai des Grands-Augustins

Albert Marquet

1905–1906 · Oil on canvas · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · CC BY-SA 2.0

The elevated position turns embankments and barges into strong diagonals beside pale water. Farther buildings merge into grey, leaving the nearer edges to organise the city. Marquet includes enough figures for movement and scale without filling every interval. Restrained colour allows the larger shapes of a busy place to remain unusually clear.

Object source · Open artwork

20 / 20

Landscape, or Street in the South

Henri Matisse

1919 · Oil on canvas-covered cardboard · Musée d’art moderne André Malraux (MuMa)



Patrick (Compiègne, France), via Wikimedia Commons. Proportional resize and JPEG compression; no crop. · Public domain

A pale road, pink building and dark trees are enough to keep the street recognisable. Matisse assigns them broad warm and cool areas rather than the many small touches in Renoir's Salerno view. Both pictures give southern light a structure. Their difference lies in how much work each patch of colour is asked to perform.

Object source · Open artwork

Follow one boundary

Choose the edge of a tower, shoulder or snowbank and see where it becomes clear, interrupted or lost. The same question travels well across this collection without making all its paintings equivalent. Check MuMa's current information before visiting for a specific work, and preserve the catalogue's qualified dates when comparing versions.

Further reading

Histoire de Édouard Manet et de son oeuvre

Théodore Duret · Read free · French

Duret's early account of Manet and his work, in French. It gives background to the reception of modern French painting, although Manet is not among this guide's selected works. Use current museum records to check older dates and attributions.

Œuvres commentées

Musée d’art moderne André Malraux · Read online · French

MuMa's free illustrated commentaries are the closest reading companion to this selection. The link opens the museum's collection resource, with entries on individual works.

Museum website · Official collection guide

Sources and visitor information checked: 2026-10-12

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